

HAUNTING HOODS

GENESIS LORE

**THE SEAL IS GONE.
THE 4,444 HAVE EMERGED.**

A story of creation, betrayal, imprisonment, and return.

BEFORE THE HOODS

For years, there had been stories.

Stories about people who disappeared. Stories about figures that appeared where they shouldn't have been. Stories about something that had been hidden away long before anyone alive could remember.

Most people dismissed them.

Urban legends. Old photographs. Unexplained incidents. Stories passed from one generation to another until nobody could remember where they had started.

But every story had something in common.

A hood.

And beneath that hood, something no one could clearly describe.

For a long time, that was all they were.

Stories.

Until people started seeing them again.

THE FIRST SIGNS

The sightings never made sense.

A figure standing alone at the end of a street. A silhouette watching from a building. Someone appearing in the background of a photograph before disappearing moments later.

People described seeing a human figure.

But something about it was wrong.

Too still. Too quiet. Too unnatural.

And strangely, those who encountered them didn't describe feeling hunted.

They described feeling watched.

Observed.

As if whatever stood in the darkness wasn't looking for them.

It was waiting.

Soon, reports began appearing from different places.

The descriptions were inconsistent. The faces were different. But the hood was always the same.

People tried to draw what they had seen. The results never matched.

Some couldn't remember the face. Some remembered a completely different one. Others couldn't even explain what they had seen.

The world was beginning to notice something it had forgotten.

But the real story had started long before the first recent sighting.

Much, much earlier.

THE EXPERIMENT

Decades before the sightings, humanity was obsessed with one question:

How far could we push the human body?

Technology had advanced faster than anyone expected. Researchers began developing experimental systems capable of manipulating energy within living tissue.

The original purpose was simple enough.

Stronger bodies. Faster healing. Greater endurance. Longer lives.

But the people funding the research wanted more.

They wanted something that would make ordinary humans obsolete.

Power. Influence. Military advantage. And eventually, something closer to immortality.

Money was offered to volunteers. A fortune in exchange for participating in an experimental program that promised to transform their lives.

They were told they would become stronger. Faster. Better.

They weren't told what the researchers had discovered.

Because even the researchers didn't fully understand it.

During one of the experiments, they encountered an energy unlike anything they had ever seen.

It behaved like energy.

But it responded like something alive.

The researchers called it the Black Energy.

They believed they had discovered the key to everything they wanted.

So they pushed the experiment further.

And further.

Until they finally crossed a line they could never undo.

THE TRANSFORMATION

The experiment worked.

But not as intended.

The subjects survived.

Their bodies changed. Their minds changed. Something inside them had awakened.

They became stronger than any human should have been.

Their bodies no longer followed the same rules.

They could survive injuries that should have killed them.

They could manipulate the Black Energy.

And eventually, they discovered something even more frightening.

The energy responded to their will.

What humanity would later call dark magic wasn't magic at all in the beginning.

It was the result of what the experiment had created.

The researchers had wanted to create superhumans.

Instead, they had created something that existed between humanity and something far darker.

The subjects stopped aging.

They could no longer die naturally.

They had become immortal.

And then the researchers realized what they had done.

They were afraid.

The experiment they had created could no longer be controlled.

THE FIRST BETRAYAL

The subjects were still human enough to understand what had happened to them.

They knew they had been used.

But they didn't want war.

They didn't want humanity destroyed.

They wanted to live.

So an agreement was made.

A pact.

The humans promised that they would never attempt to destroy or imprison the transformed subjects.

In return, the subjects promised never to use their abilities against humanity.

For a time, the pact held.

The transformed humans disappeared from society. They lived away from civilization, hiding what they had become.

The world continued.

The experiment became a secret.

And eventually, almost everyone forgot.

But fear has a way of returning.

The humans who created them never truly stopped fearing them.

And fear eventually became something worse.

Greed.

The same people who had wanted their power now wanted to control it.

They began searching for a way to contain the transformed subjects.

Then they found one.

A way to create something powerful enough to imprison beings that could not be killed.

A barrier.

A prison.

A seal.

THE SEAL

The humans broke the pact.

The transformed subjects were captured.

They fought.

But the humans were prepared.

The seal was activated.

One by one, the transformed humans were dragged beyond it.

They were imprisoned in a place separated from the world they once knew.

The humans had won.

Or so they thought.

The seal could not kill them.

It could only contain them.

And before they were imprisoned, the subjects learned the truth.

The people who had promised them freedom had betrayed them.

The people they once trusted had decided that their existence was too dangerous.

They were no longer considered human.

They were prisoners.

And the world moved on without them.

YEARS BECAME DECADES

The prisoners waited.

Then waited longer.

The humans who had betrayed them died. Their families disappeared. Their cities changed. Generations came and went.

But the Hoods remained.

Immortal. Trapped. Forgotten.

And something began changing inside them.

The anger that had once been directed at the people who betrayed them became something much larger.

Hatred survived longer than the humans who created it.

The Hoods no longer wanted revenge against the people responsible.

Those people were already dead.

Their anger had outlived its original target.

It became hatred for the entire world.

Humanity had created them.

Humanity had used them.

Humanity had betrayed them.

Humanity had sealed them away.

And eventually, they reached a conclusion.

There would be no revenge.

There would be no forgiveness.

There would be no second chance.

Humanity itself would pay.

THE PHOTOGRAPH

Twenty-three years ago, something happened that would later become the first real evidence that the seal was failing.

One of the Hoods escaped.

For the first time, one of them crossed back into the human world.

Someone saw it.

Someone managed to photograph it.

The photograph was strange.

The figure was distant. The image was unclear. But it was enough.

A hooded figure stood where no one should have been.

The photograph was investigated.

Then dismissed.

There was no explanation for what had been captured.

The incident slowly disappeared from public memory.

But the Hood had not disappeared.

It had returned to the seal.

And it had learned something.

The seal could be weakened.

THE TWENTY-THREE YEAR PLAN

The Hood began working from the outside.

Using the same dark energy that had once been created through the experiments, it learned to manipulate the seal itself.

It began performing rituals.

Slowly.

Carefully.

Over and over again.

Every ritual weakened the barrier.

Every fracture brought the seal closer to collapse.

But twenty-three years was not enough for the Hood to break it completely.

So it waited.

And worked.

And waited.

Until the first cracks began appearing.

Something began slipping through.

At first, only one.

Then another.

Then more.

The sightings began again.

THE HOODS RETURN

People started seeing them.

Not clearly.

Never clearly.

A figure in the distance. A shadow where there shouldn't be one. A hood disappearing around a corner. A face that someone could swear they remembered — until they tried to describe it.

The sightings spread.

The same hood.

Different faces.

Nobody understood why.

Nobody understood where they were coming from.

But the truth was already unfolding.

The seal was failing.

And every time another Hood crossed through, the barrier became weaker.

The escaped Hood had spent twenty-three years preparing the way.

And now the others were beginning to follow.

WHY THE FACES ARE DIFFERENT

The faces were never the identity of the Hoods.

They were what remained of the humans they had once been.

Every transformed subject had been altered by the experiment differently.

Their bodies, minds and connection to the Black Energy had changed in different ways.

The Hood became the one constant.

The faces became manifestations of what remained beneath it.

That was why witnesses could never agree.

They weren't all seeing the same face.

They were seeing different remnants of what the Hoods had once been.

But beneath every face was the same history.

The same betrayal.

The same darkness.

The same desire to see the world that imprisoned them fall.

WHY 4,444?

Beyond the seal, there were thousands.

But there were exactly 4,444 who survived the transformation and remained imprisoned.

For generations, they waited together in the darkness.

4,444 lives that humanity had changed forever.

4,444 beings that had been promised freedom and given imprisonment instead.

4,444 Hoods waiting for the seal to fail.

And eventually, it did.

THE FINAL BREACH

The seal had been weakened for twenty-three years.

The damage became impossible to contain.

The cracks spread.

The barrier began collapsing.

More Hoods crossed into the world.

Then more.

Until there was almost nothing left between the two sides.

The final ritual was completed.

The seal broke.

Completely.

For the first time in generations, nothing remained between the Hoods and humanity.

And then they came through.

Not one.

Not dozens.

Not hundreds.

All 4,444.

The figures people had been seeing were only the beginning.

The photographs were only fragments.

The sightings were only warnings.

The Hoods were never coming back for a handful of humans.

They were coming back for the entire world.

THE TRUTH

Who are the Hoods?

They were once human — ordinary people transformed by an experiment designed by humans obsessed with power.

What happened to them?

The experiment changed them beyond recognition, giving them extraordinary abilities, immortality and a connection to the Black Energy that became known as dark magic.

Why were they sealed?

Humanity became afraid of what it had created and broke its promise to them, imprisoning them instead of allowing them to exist freely.

Why do they hate humanity?

Because humanity didn't simply create them. It exploited them, betrayed them, and imprisoned them after promising it would never do so. Their original hatred was directed at the people responsible. But centuries of isolation changed that hatred into something much larger.

Why did the seal weaken?

Twenty-three years ago, one Hood escaped and discovered a way to manipulate the seal using dark magic. For twenty-three years, it worked from the outside, slowly weakening the barrier and creating a path for the others.

What was the old photograph?

The first known evidence of that escape. The first Hood had already crossed into our world twenty-three years ago.

Why did more Hoods begin appearing?

Because the seal was weakening. Every fracture allowed more of them to cross through.

Why could nobody see them clearly?

The Hoods were crossing through a weakening barrier, and their appearances in our world were unstable. Witnesses saw only fragments of something that was not yet fully here.

Why are there 4,444?

Because 4,444 transformed humans remained beyond the seal.

What do they want?

Not revenge. Not justice. Destruction. Their rage has outlived the people who caused it. They no longer distinguish between the guilty and the innocent. Humanity itself has become the target.

THE END OF THE BEGINNING

The seal is gone.

The prison is open.

The 4,444 are here.

They have waited for generations. They have carried their rage through decades of darkness. And now there is nothing left to contain it.

They were once humans.

They wanted power.

Humanity gave it to them.

Humanity created them.

Humanity betrayed them.

And now humanity will face what it created.

THE HOODS HAVE EMERGED.

AND THEY ARE COMING FOR THE WORLD.

This is not the end of their story.

This is where it begins.